

Under its G20 presidency, India advocates for a diverse global policy palette on transition, allowing countries to select from various pricing and non-pricing strategies, from carbon taxes to green technology standards, based on their unique situations.

Further, India's experience has been that true transformation only comes from mass movements, from people's participation. Our Mission LiFE seeks to make the fight against climate change a mass movement by focussing on lifestyle transformation. When every individual knows that they can make a direct difference to the welfare of the planet, results will be much more broad-based.

Q: There are also other important financial issues that are a part of India's G20 agenda, including debt restructuring for countries facing high levels of sovereign debt. What has been the progress on these and how hopeful are you of a consensus on these issues during India's presidency?

A: Financial discipline is very important for all countries.

42 | It is the duty of each country to guard itself from financial indiscipline but at the same time there are forces that have sought to take undue advantage by catalysing debt crises. These forces have capitalised on the helplessness of other countries and led them into debt traps.

The G20 has prioritised addressing debt vulnerabilities in low- and middle-income countries since 2021. Achieving the 2030 SDG agenda depends on these countries' progress, yet debt servicing hinders their efforts, limiting fiscal space for SDG investments.

In 2023, under India's presidency, the G20 gave a significant boost to debt restructuring through the Common Framework. Before India's lead, only Chad underwent debt restructuring under this framework. With India's focus, Zambia, Ethiopia, and Ghana have made notable advancements. India played a pivotal role, being a key creditor.

Outside the Common Framework, G20 forums facilitated debt restructuring coordination for Sri Lanka, with a committee co-chaired by India, Japan, and France.

The Indian presidency also saw the inception of the Global Sovereign Debt Roundtable, co-chaired by the

IMF, World Bank, and G20 presidency. The Roundtable aims to strengthen communication and foster a common understanding among key stakeholders, both within and outside the Common Framework, for facilitating effective debt treatments.

Q: There has been talk of a global framework for regulation of cryptocurrencies. What has been the progress on this?

A: The rapid pace of change of technology is a reality—there is no point in ignoring it or wishing it away. Instead, the focus should be on adoption, democratisation and a unified approach. At the same time, the rules, regulations and framework around it should not belong to one country or a group of countries.

So not only crypto, but all emerging technologies need a global framework and regulations.

A global consensus-based model is needed, especially one which considers the concerns of the Global

South. We can learn from the field of aviation. Be it air traffic control or air security, there are common global rules and regulations governing the sector.

In the past nine months, vast efforts and energy have been channelled into debt and crypto agendas. India's G20 presidency expanded the crypto conversation beyond financial stability to consider its broader macroeconomic implications, especially for emerging markets and de-

veloping economies. The G20 reached a consensus on these matters, guiding standard-setting bodies accordingly. Our presidency also hosted enriching seminars and discussions, deepening insights into crypto assets.

We haven't stopped at ideating on how we should move ahead. We have also come up with tangible details on the way ahead and how quickly we need to move. So, our road map is detailed and action-oriented.

Q: India has taken up the important agenda of reforming the multilateral development bank (MDB) structure. Previous efforts have not had much impact. To what extent are you hoping that India's presidency will take this key agenda forward?

A: On the MDB agenda, the efforts in the G20, till recently, have been primarily focussed on how their bal-

“The G20 group is being looked at as a ray of hope by the world and the ground for this is being laid during India's presidency of G20”